

THE DEATH OF SHERLOCK HOLMES



EXTRA CASE- BY CODY FLEMING
2 DECEMBER 1893

NOTES:

REQUIRES THE BASE GAME RULES, DIRECTORY AND MAP TO PLAY.

SOME ADDRESSES IN THE SOUTH AND EAST AREAS ARE INCLUDED IN THIS CASE.

THEATRE ADDRESSES IN THE DIRECTORY'S CATEGORY LISTINGS SHOULD BE VERIFIED IN THE ALPHABETICAL LISTING OR ON THE MAP.

EXTRA CASE

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We've never seen Dr. John Watson as devastated as we do when we walk upon the crime scene. His head lays tilted off to one side as he sits, slouching against a crate on the sidewalk. He seems in a stupor as we call his name again.

"John?"

Not receiving a reply, we survey the scene again. The ruins of 221B Baker Street are still smoking as we look from police officer to police officer, rushing about in a frenzied hum- each going through the motions, but unable to concentrate. Beyond the police cordon, there is an ever-growing throng of onlookers- no doubt word spread fast. There is a small collection of evidence being brought from the former study at 221B that has been saved from the conflagration.

The final item is the most important, but the one no one wants to acknowledge. Under a sheet near Dr. Watson lies the body of Sherlock Holmes.

"John?" Inspector Lestrade whispers again.

"...sorry. It's just that..."

"I know," Lestrade continues. "This is the most terrible scene I can imagine. Holmes was a friend to all of us, though I know you two were particularly close. Still, I doubt Sherlock would have burned his own apartment down, so we owe it to him to be investigators first and mourn for him second. We will have our time to remember and reflect, but for now we should see about getting some justice for Holmes while the trail may still be warm."



Watson shakes his head and nods. "You're right. I'm sorry. You know I am not a trained detective or police officer. I may have helped Sherlock as he solved countless crimes, but I don't have a hardened stomach for this type of thing."

"We understand, John. If you could provide us any assistance, we'd appreciate it. Has an autopsy been performed?"

"No."

"Well, usually we'd send the body for a coroner for the official report, but you know the sensitivity of this one, John. Do you think? Would you?"

"You want me to perform the autopsy on my best friend?"

"It would speed things up, John. It certainly seems like someone did this to Holmes. I refuse to believe this an accident. Wiggins, go and see what other evidence has been recovered from the scene of the crime."

The next ten minutes are very hard to stomach. Lestrade winces each time Watson pokes the charred remains of Holmes's body. It's one thing to see a dead body, it's another when it's someone you loved.

*"Well, this is just a cursory glance, mind you, but here's what I found. Sher--*ahem*--the subject was indeed burned, and the result could have been fatal. I would estimate approximately 85% of the subject's body suffered second or third degree burns. And while the fire would have been enough to kill a prone man, say one that was sleeping, Sher- the subject- appears to have a secondary injury. There is a small pair of wounds consistent with a gunshot wound as well. The size of the wounds would indicate that a bullet entered his back and exited his stomach. As the wounds are cauterized and instantly scarred from the heat, it is impossible to tell if the shooting occurred before or after the body began to burn."*

"Dear God, John, are you saying he was burned and shot?"

"It appears so, though, again, I can't say for sure which happened first. I don't know why you'd shoot a burning man, though."

"Anything else?"

"Nothing of interest. The subject was in relatively good health, walked frequently, and was of a slightly average weight and..."

"John?"

"For God's sake, Inspector, it's Holmes! This is Holmes we're talking about."

"Did the sub- did Holmes have any other identifying articles?"

"Clothes were incinerated, nothing else was found on the body."

"Thank you, John. I know this is a very hard time, but you've helped us quite a bit."

We rejoin, and Wiggins shares the findings from the smoldering study.

"Inspector, you probably won't believe this, but for a crime scene involving a fire, a fair amount of evidence was recovered from the crime scene. This was largely due to a large iron box that is believed to have been on Sherlock's desk. Sundry items were found inside."

"Including?"

"Well, there were a series of programs from theaters- The Allegro, The Lyceum, and The Olympia. They are dated within the last several months. The same box contained a carriage receipt from early yesterday. There was also a matchbook, partially used."

"How did a book of matches, of all things, not burn in a fire, Wiggins?"

"As, I stated, Inspector, these items were left in an iron box in the study. As to why Sherlock would keep such items in a box, I haven't the slightest clue."

"Perplexing. Was anything else recovered from the scene?"

"There were also two notes in the box, Inspector."

*S,
No harm will come
of it, I promise!
-M.*

2 December 1893

Lestrade,

Analysis
will
further
aid.
Best
examine
remaining

"As you can tell, Inspector, the second note appears to make no sense. It's almost like he was interrupted and stopped writing."

"Why was he writing a note to me? It's dated today, Wiggins! What can that mean?"

"I have no idea, Inspector. We have a few minor things that are not from the crime scene itself, however, we also noticed a small pile of glass on the rear sidewalk across the street from 221B Baker St. We're not sure if it's related or not. There was also the report of a woman screaming near the same time as we believe the fire to have been started."

"Thank you, Wiggins, that was very comprehensive."

"Oh, I almost forgot what could be the most important thing! It appears we have a principle witness to some of the goings on." A Ms. Olivia Robins of 50 NW. She lives across the street and reports that she saw Sherlock meet with a man that may have been his brother about 8:30. This was before the fire broke out. We estimate the fire must have started around 9 o'clock. That's everything. Where should we get started, Inspector Lestrade?"

"We're like little kids in the dark, Wiggins. I fear the only person who would know where to start...isn't around to tell us anymore."

AREA E

98 E

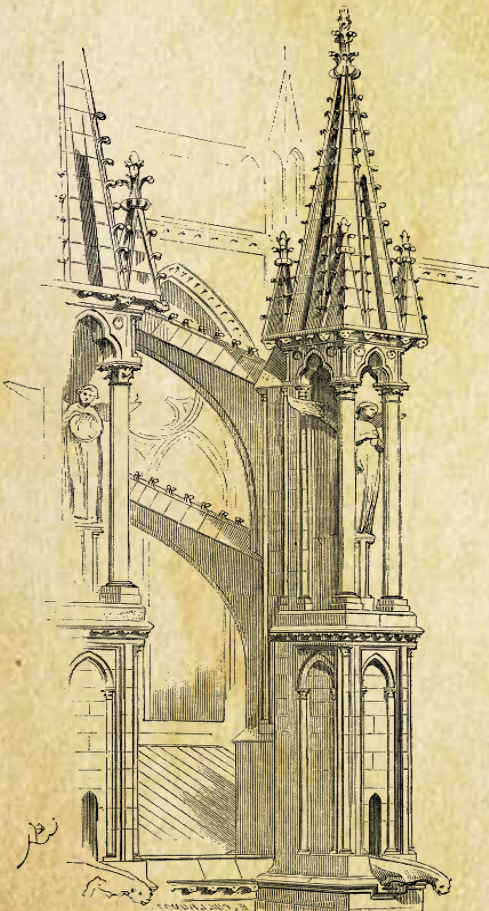
The Outer Docks is bustling with activity as we arrive. Crates are being loaded and unloaded onto several large ships, sturdy wooden barrels are being rolled back and forth, and large sacks of various goods are being transported in every direction. There doesn't appear to be a person to talk to, and to talk to everyone would take days. Hundreds of workers are being replaced by hundreds more as the burn of commerce continues on, unimpeded by the death of Sherlock Holmes.

"Are you the new security? Oh, Officers. I'm sorry. I didn't realize. I'm looking for Ambrose again. I can't find him anywhere, and we need security on this shipment. Do you want to make some side money?"

"No, thank you. Do you mean Ambrose Beaupre?"

"You know him? He works security for us. He's a menacing figure. I don't know many guys that can scare away armed men while only carrying his trusty shillelagh, but he can. This is the first time he's missed work in as long as I can remember."

"Sorry we can't help you, but please let us know if you see him."



AREA EC

5 EC

We're met by gunfire as we approach the Grant Arms Company. Quickly taking cover, we realize it is merely the shooting gallery located in the alley behind the building. We enter the small, brown, outdated, wooden building and are surprised to see so many people inside admiring guns and even knives. A large man with a small tattoo of an eagle on his cheek approaches us.

"What would Scotland Yard need to send officers to this place for?"

"How did you know we were from Scotland Yard?"

"The handle of the gun sticking out of your holster. Kind of small, isn't it? It's standard issue for Scotland Yard, though. Am I right?"

"That you are, Sir. I'm Inspector Lestrade, and this is Wiggins. And you are...?"

"Oliver Perkins, owner and operator of Grant Arms Co. What can I do for you gentlemen?"

"Two things, one personal, one business."

"Let me have the business first."

"We're investigating a possible murder that involves a shot fired from a shooter on a second story window to a victim in a first story apartment some fifty feet away. And it appears that the shot was taken through at least one pane of glass, possibly two, and still managed to hit the target near the heart. Here's the cartridge we found at the scene. It might be from a Webley?" We hand him the small gun shell.

Perkins rubs his chin. "That's an older gun, almost twenty years old now. That shell is a .44 caliber from a Webley, but a smaller type called a "Bull Dog." This type of gun tops out at 50 feet. What you've described would be a mighty impressive shot. There's a few things wrong, though. First, why would a shooter not merely open the window? Secondly, at that distance, why would you not use a longer range firearm? We have guns here that can knock out a man's tooth at 100 yards."

"Those were the same questions we had, Sir. Window aside, how many men in London could make such a shot?"

"At that range and with that gun? Two."

"That was a fast answer. How do you know?"

"I run a firearm shop. I know who the best shooters are in London. The only two men that could have made that shot are a man named Chandler Davenport...and myself."

"Well, you won't like the personal question then. What is your relationship with Israel Jacobs?"

"Israel? What's that boy up to now?"

"He is home sick today, and he is under suspicion of being involved with the shooting we were just mentioning. Someone unlocked a room at the Camden House and allowed a shooter access to a prime vantage point. We're still putting pieces together. When is the last time you spoke to Mr. Jacobs?"

Perkins sits on a rickety, old wooden stool. "Eh, I'm ashamed to say it's been over a year."

"Over a year? Aren't you his stepfather?"

"His mother, Faye, is in prison. Israel never liked that his mother and I were married. And, to be honest, I never liked the kid either. The fact that you've brought up Chandler Davenport makes me worry."

"How's that?"

"Israel used to spend a lot of time here in my shop. It was his mother's idea. She wanted him to get to know me a bit by seeing where I worked and what guns were like. However, he never was good at shooting. Israel has a condition that makes shooting all but impossible— if you want to hit a target, that is. However, he started hanging out with Chandler Davenport when he would come into the shop and practice on the range in the alley. Davenport is a good enough guy socially, but I always suspected he was into some activities that Israel shouldn't have been involved in. Even though I didn't like the kid, I don't want any harm to come to him. It wouldn't surprise me if they still talk from time to time."

"Does Chandler Davenport still come into your shop?"

"Ah, no. We had a falling out a while back. He was being reckless on the shooting gallery. He was so good that he was cocky. Throwing a gun into the air and catching it and firing at a target for example. He was always trying to prove that he was the best shooter in London, but he went about it in all the wrong ways. He was blindfolded shooting apples off of people's heads and hands when I walked out of the shop and put an end to it and his time in my shop."

"Did he hit the apples?"

Perkins gets off his stool and begins to polish a gun barrel. "Every damn one."

10 EC

The proprietor of Poole & Co., a very baughty fashion mart, acknowledges that she knows who Sherlock is, but that he has never entered her shop or purchased anything from Poole & Co.

29 EC

The office appears closed. There is a note on the front door that simply has a stick figure drawn in black pen.

30 EC

Henry Ellis meets us as we enter the London Times' office.

"Lestrade. I'm holding off on running this article on Sherlock Holmes. I can only give you a few hours, though. It's my duty to report, even if it is on Sherlock Holmes. Now what I am to make of this report I received about three suspects being at the scene of the crime?"

"Three suspects?"

"You're not corroborating that?"

"No."

"I received a tip from a Dirkin Topper. He was apparently walking past a little after 9 o'clock when he saw three people leave from the scene. A man, a woman, and and a third figure dressed in black. The man and woman went off together, but the figure in black left after the other two had gone."

35 EC

Quintin Hogg jumps to his feet the moment we step into his office.

"Thank goodness you're here. I've just received an anonymous tip!"

"What is it?"

"Do you remember that incident at the Outer Docks two years ago? The smuggling ring that ended in the death of an officer? I have it on good authority that there were some shadowy leaders involved in that whole deal. I hear that the organizer was actually one of the people apprehended, but that there was another organizer in the shadows somewhere that was really the brains behind the operation."

"So you're telling us that there might be someone who might have worked for someone else on a case that took place two years ago? Do you have any names to provide?"

"No."

"Thanks a ton. Really."

36 EC

Edward Hall's secretary informs you that he has gone on vacation to a remote Pacific island.

38 EC

"I'm afraid I have nothing to offer you. I'm told John Watson performed the autopsy. If you're wanting a second opinion, I'll take a look at the corpse."

52 EC

The Raven and Rat Tavern is remarkably empty today. Still, Porky Shinwell stands behind the bar almost as chipper as ever.

"My condolences, Gentlemen. Sherlock was a myth among men. I'll assume you're here combing the city for information?"

"You're correct, Porky. Do you have anything for us? I have to assume something has floated through here in the last several days or week."

"Here's the deal. Rumor has it that two people burned down Sherlock's flat. I heard that one of them was careless and caught fire as they were doing the job. There must have been a witness, because I've hear the job was performed by a man and a woman."

"Anything else, Porky? Think real hard. Don't forget all the times we've stopped in for a pint and have traded a tip for a tip."

"Well played, Sir. I do have one other tidbit that floated through here a few days ago. Apparently someone spilled a drink on Holmes at a cafe the other day. Well, I heard the same person bought Sherlock a drink the next week, and he had no recollection of it ever happening. I tell ya, it's like his mind was slipping. Perhaps he was losing his touch, eh?"

53 EC

We knock on the door of the home of Israel Jacobs, and a young, meek man answers the door.

"Can- can I help you?"

He appears nervous and looks from one of us to the other.

"Mr. Jacobs?"

"Yes, that's right."

"Aren't you supposed to be at work?" "You came to check up on me because I'm not at work? Who sent you?"

"Mr. Jacobs, we're from Scotland Yard. We spoke to your employer earlier. We're investigating a crime and following up on a lead. Can you tell us if you own a gun, Mr. Jacobs?"

"No, I do not."

"Are you experienced with firearms?" "No."

"Have you ever shot a gun?"

"No, and I wouldn't be very good with one if I tried either." He holds up his hands, and we watch at they both shake involuntarily.

"What's this?"

"Condition I have. I've had it my whole life. You see, I wouldn't be very good with a gun even if I wanted to be. It makes it very hard to get work. I'm glad to have the job I do. Now if you'll excuse me, my head is spinning, and I need to lay down."

"One more thing, Mr. Jacobs. Can you tell me why, if you have no experience with firearms, you have this pad of paper?" I pick up a small, yellowed notepad from the table near the door. The paper has a letterhead stating, "Who Says You Can't? Stop By and Visit Grant! Grant Firearms- For All Your Firearms Needs."

Israel Jacobs goes white. "Look. I am telling you the truth. I've never held a gun before in my life. My mother married the guy that runs Grant. I don't like him, but paper comes in handy. Now, if you gentlemen will excuse me." He ushers us out, and quietly shuts the door.

73 EC

There is no response at the home of Marvin Pemberton, but we find the door open and help ourselves to entering.

"Mr. Pemberton? Are you home?" There is nothing of interest in the first several rooms of the small flat, but upon entering Pemberton's bedroom, we're struck by quite a sight.

The bedroom walls are littered with newspaper clippings involving police cases. They just seem random until Wiggins pieces them together.

"Inspector! These are all cases that Sherlock Holmes helped Scotland Yard solve."

"Are you sure, Wiggins?"

"Yes, Sir. I'm quite fond of Mr. Holmes's handiwork as well."

"Interesting."

The closet of the house is full of tweed overcoats and deerstalker hats- both the type Sherlock would wear. Upon looking at the desk in the room, we find a three note cards:



M,
Stop by at 8:45. I'm sorry
to say it's not for what you
expect.

-S

M,
You're good. I'll give you that.
However, I don't enjoy going to a
restaurant and finding I already
have a bill charged in my name.

-S

M,
With deepest flattery, I was in
the shop the other day. It's
impressive. The only one you
can't fool is me.

-S

The note cards do not appear to be in any particular order and are not dated.

74 EC

The house of Gertrude Helwig is bright white, with well-trimmed grass and bushes and a deep-red fence that surrounds the property. We find a package from Bon Marche on the front step. We knock three times before she answers the door. She is a lovely woman in her early thirties. She wears a beautiful blue dress with a zigzag pattern and a pink overcoat.

"Ms. Helwig?" We extend our right hands to shake, but Helwig just smiles at us.

"Yes?"

"Can you tell us where you were last night?"

"I was at the Lyceum Theater rehearsing my parts. I'm the lead in a new show that debuts tonight."

"You weren't near 221B Baker St. last night were you?"

She flashes a smile. "No, good heavens. I don't have time to go traipsing around town, Gentlemen. I have a show

to open tonight. Now if you'll excuse me, I must gather my things."

"Sure thing. Thanks for answering our questions. Oh, one more thing." Inspector Lestrade pauses to pick up the package from the porch. "Some mail for you."

"Oh? Just some new clothes. Thank you." Mrs. Helwig extends her left arm easily, but grimaces in pain when she extends her right arm to help support the weight of the package.

83 EC

The weathered sign displaying a green turtle in the foreground and a sailing ship in the background hangs outside our destination. The Ship and Turtle, or "Sbit and Purtle" as some locals refer to it, is a run-down eatery specializing in seafood.

"Two for a table?" greets a lovely woman.

"No, thank you. We're here on official business from Scotland Yard. Can you tell us if Sherlock Holmes has been in here recently?"

"Don't know him."

"Dignified man, mostly quiet, wears tweed cloaks and overcoats, deerstalker hat?"

"Hmm, it does sound a little familiar."

"We heard that he may have been involved in an accident here yesterday involving a barrel. Were you working yesterday?"

"Oh, yes! I was, and I remember. Yeab, older gentleman, dressed in brown. He was walking down the sidewalk, and one of our supply barrels apparently slipped out of the store room and hit him. Poor guy. Is he doing OK?"

"He's dead."

Her jaw drops, and she stand flabbergasted.

"How? It wasn't that serious..."

"It wasn't related to the barrel, M'am."

"Oh, thank goodness."

"Can you tell us who let the barrel slip?"

"I'm not sure. We have two young men that work back in the supply room. They were both here yesterday. One is named Mitchell Rourke, he's a larger guy, tattoo on his arm. Nice enough fella. The other is named Israel. I don't know as much about him, but he seems even nicer than Mitchell."

"Is either one here now?"

"No, I'm sorry, we only get supplies on certain days of the week. They're both off today. I can tell them you're looking for them, though, if that will help."

AREA NW

16 NW

As we enter the shop of Tetley & Butler, the man at the counter barely lifts his head to glance at us.

"Excuse us, we're wondering if you can help us. We're looking around to see if Sherlock Holmes may have stopped in here yesterday.

"Who?"

"Sherlock Holmes, a detective in London. He died yesterday night, and we have reason to believe that he purchased some new clothing yesterday before his...death."

As Lestrade finishes his sentence, he notices the back of the clothing shop which doubles as a small haberdashery. In particular, a variety of deerstalker hats, such as the ones Sherlock was known to wear, catch our attention.

"Do you sell a lot of those deerstalkers?"

"Hab, not really. Not a big seller. It's a bit of an old fashioned, but we do have a man that keeps buying them from us. Tall, older gentleman, appearing sophisticated, refined, you know?"

"That sounds like Holmes."

"Holmes? No, as I've said, I've never heard of anyone by that name. This chap's name is...Pemberton, I believe."

"Can you tell us anything else?"

He shakes his head, and we thank him for his time and leave the establishment.

18 NW

Sam Parsons meets us at the counter and smiles. "Something here for you."

He places a large wind up toy on the counter. Wiggins twists the knob through several revolutions and then watches as a circle of five lumberjacks, complete with red tin flannels, take turns swinging their axes at a stump in the middle of the toy. On the top of the stump is a painted owl."

"That's gruesome."

Parsons smiles again, and, as we turn to leave the shop, shouts, "But who's twisting the knob?"

20 NW

We enter The Pavilion, a pub that reeks of seediness and infamy. Unsure of whom to speak to, we sit down in a dimly-lit corner booth.

"Wiggins, look at that symbol behind the bar..."



A vivacious redhead approaches our table, and we order two pints of ale. Explaining to our waitress who we are and what we are doing, she introduces herself as Annette Verlaine. "Sherlock Holmes? There was a man in here named 'Holmes' just yesterday about 2 o'clock it was. I remember it like it was yesterday. Oh, it was yesterday! Anyway, I was working the floor as I usually do while Elle was manning the counter. This fella comes in and just sits for an hour. I ask him three times if he wanted to order something, and finally he says he'd have a cup of tea. I went to prepare it, and Elle stopped me at the counter. She said she'd take it to him herself and insisted on making it also. Well, as we were talking, this Holmes guy is watching us like the hawk, right? Elle tells me to take the tea to him, and I do. He sat there for a moment while just looking around the room. He stared at Elle and sniffed his tea. He sniffed it again, got up, left some money on the table, and left. I hadn't seen him before, and I haven't seen him since.

"M'am, can you tell us who this 'Elle' is you keep referring to? Is she here now?"

"Oh! I'm sorry, I'm referring to Ms. Elle Fanning, the owner of The Pavilion. She's a great woman, and she's taught me so much. She does allow some dangerous looking people in here sometimes, though. A few days back she attended to a small meeting in the private room in back. I saw the last two men walk in, and they were very dangerous looking. One kept spinning a gun on his finger as he walked through the pub, and the other kept smacking a club into his palm. Very menacing chaps. Anyway, Elle is off today."

We thank her for the information, finish our drinks, and head out.

50 NW

As the door opens, Olivia Robins, an elderly woman who stands partially hunched over, greets us.

"It took you long enough to come see me! I told the officers outside the fire that I had information, that I saw things, and they just brushed me away. Are you here to

listen now? Are you here to get some answers to who killed Sherlock Holmes?"

"You know it was Sherlock Holmes's residence that was burned? Did you know Sherlock Holmes?"

"We were acquaintances. I'd stopped him in the street a few times and congratulated him on helping you bumbling boys from Scotland Yard on several occasions."

Lestrade blushes as she continues.

"Here's the deal. I live alone. My hobby is observation. I look out my window all the time. I keep up with the news and the papers. I'm an informed citizen of London, Sir, an informed citizen."

"Uh, yes. I see. Still, you haven't told us anything about the case at hand."

"I'm getting there. Don't you lecture me, young man—I'm going to give you the facts to solve this case. Trust me. Now, as I was saying before being so rudely interrupted, Sherlock was outside his residence at 8:30 when his brother arrived, and they spoke for a minute. His brother left, and I went to check on my teas. When I looked back Sherlock had gone into his apartment."

"Did you know his brother as well?"

"Only by face. I've never met him, but I've certainly seen him come to visit Sherlock many times in the past years. It was his brother, alright. Now, here's where things get interesting. Do you know who Edward Beaupre is?"

Wiggins and I look at each other. "We do, M'am. How do you know who he is?"

"I've already told you, I keep up on the news in London. An informed citizen is a productive member of society, you know. Anyway, Edward Beaupre was in the papers a year ago. Dirty dog, that one."

"That's more or less correct, M'am."

"More or less? Anyway, I looked back out my window later, and there was a chap that looked a lot like Edward Beaupre outside Sherlock Holmes's house last night at 9 o'clock. It was getting dark, but I'd still bet money that somehow Beaupre was there even though he was supposed to be in prison. But that's not the weirdest part. He wasn't alone. Beaupre was with a woman dressed in a flashy red dress. And she was wearing, well, something like a theatrical mask. It looked like the happy face. You know, from those happy and sad faces you always see around theater stuff?"

"This is all very interesting, Ms. Robins. Do you have anything else for us?"

"Here's the part that fills in the missing pieces. I saw

Beaupre pour kerosene oil around the walls of Sherlock's home, and then the woman lit a match, held it to the sky, and threw it on the house. They walked away just as the first people arrived on the scene. At that point, I started outside to yell for help."

"Thank you, Ms. Robins. If even half of what you've said turns out to be true, you've done your city a great service."

"I'll expect a badge next week," she says and laughs shrilly. "In all seriousness, though, London has lost a great man. I wish you the best of luck in finding the heatben who did this to him."

53 NW

Wilkie Gunderson, the proprietor of the Camden House smiles as he greets us from the ornate desk that welcomes customers.

"What can I do for you, Gentlemen?"

"Hello, Lestrade. Wiggins. We're investigating the fire across the street that occurred last night."

"Ah, yes, Sherlock Holmes's house."

"You knew him?"

"Not personally, but I've been the proprietor at the Camden House for almost ten years since my mother passed. I didn't know him, but being right across the street from him, I knew of him. Are you looking for witnesses to the fire? I'm not sure why you'd come here looking for information otherwise."

"I'll admit this is a bit of a stretch, but a small pile of glass was found outside your building. It's probably nothing, but we're investigating everything all the same."

"Well, we can check all the rooms that face 221B Baker St. if you'd like."

"Thank you, that would be most helpful."

The two downstairs rooms are occupied and the occupants have nothing to add to the case. The first room upstairs is occupied and nothing is found out of the ordinary.

"The last room on this side of the building is unoccupied and has been empty for quite a while. Still, we can take a look inside." Gunderson bumps the door, and it slowly swings open. "Why isn't this room locked?"

An acrid, but familiar, stench assaults our nostrils as soon as we open the door. The room is empty of possessions, the bed is made, and the room seems to be in good order.

"It smells like something's burnt," Wiggins offers.

It doesn't take long to find the reason. The window

facing 221B Baker St. is shattered, and glass pieces litter the small oval table below the window.

"I think we can surmise that the window was broken before the fire due to the heavy smell that permeates this room. But I don't know that it makes the broken window connected to the fire, Wiggins. Unless..."

On the floor near the oval table, we see a shell from a bullet of a small firearm. "This is something new. Why was this room unlocked?"

Gunderson stammers, "It- it- it shouldn't be! I always keep the rooms locked unless they are rented."

"Who else has a key to the rooms?"

"I have a cleaning crew. I suppose any of them could have taken the key from the cupboard downstairs."

"Are they all presently at work?"

"All except one." Gunderson pauses. "Mr. Jacobs didn't show up to work yet. Israel Jacobs. He's been our newest worker- signed on about a week ago. Pleasant lad. He's a hard worker and we've never had any trouble from him. I can't imagine he's involved in any trouble."

We thank Gunderson for his assistance and exit the Camden House.

"Inspector," Wiggins begins, "something has me confused. The bullet appears to be from a modified .44 caliber gun. I'd take the casing to mean that someone tried taking a shot at Holmes's flat...but that has to be a forty or fifty foot shot. Why would someone use a short-range handgun?"

Lestrade stares at the smoldering ruins of 221B Baker St. but doesn't answer.



72 NW

The small room that is John Taylor Chemist is filled with various beakers, tubes, and Bunsen burners. John Taylor himself greets us.

"Hello, what can I do for you?"

"We're from Scotland Yard, and we're tracking down leads on an investigation. Can you reveal customer records?"

"I can try. Some purchases have records if they are for imported chemicals. If we create a solution here for a customer, there is no paper receipt. What exactly are you looking for?"

"Can you tell us what you sold to Ms. Elle Fanning that comes in a crate?"

"Elle Fanning? The name sounds familiar."

"She owns and runs The Pavilion pub, if that helps."

"Oh, yes. I remember. She purchased a container of cyanide."

"Cyanide? Is that a normal thing for a person owning a pub to purchase?"

Taylor laughs. "It wasn't for the pub. She is an amateur photographer. Cyanide is used to create sepia tones in photography. I'm not a photographer, so I can't tell you the appeal of a sepia tone, but I could draw you out some chemical formulas of how it works if you wish."

"No, that's OK. Thank you."

89 NW

We enter the Tichfield Police Station and are greeted by an officer at the front desk. Our presence attracts more officers. A captain steps forward and shakes our hands.

"Inspector Lestrade. Office Wiggins. We're very sorry to hear about Sherlock Holmes. Word travels quickly. Holmes spent his life helping right wrongs and stop crime. Though he was never officially a member of a police force, in many ways he was was a more a symbol of civic duty than the police."

"Kind words, thank you very much. I'm afraid it's his death that brings us here. We have reason to believe that his death may not have been an accident."

"You must be jesting."

"I'm afraid not. One of our leads brings us here. Do you know a woman named Elle Fanning?"

"Little Elle?" The captain asks. "Sure, we all know her. Or those of us that have been here a while. She practically grew up in this police station. Her father was Dick Alpert,

one of the finest officers we've ever had. He was a decorated officer active into his seventies. For a long time it seemed like he was never going to die. Tough old guy. The way policemen used to be."

"Refresh me. What happened to him?"

"He was the lone casualty in the smuggling ring that was stopped on the Outer Docks, one, no, two years ago. We never found out who shot him, but it was presumed to be one of the operatives in the smuggling ring."

"I remember the case, now that you said it. I hate to ask, but was Sherlock Holmes involved?"

"Of course, he tipped us off on the lead that led to the arrest and shut down of the operation. Here, let me give you the clipping. We kept it on the wall because of Officer Alpert's death."

18 Nov 1891

SMUGGLING RING APPREHENDED AT OUTER DOCKS

In what can only be described as one of the largest apprehensions in recent London history, the Tichfield Police Station working in cooperation with the Thames Division Police Station were tipped off about a smuggling ring involving rare artifacts and other precious items being stolen and sold on the docks of Outer Dock. Five smugglers were apprehended in the arrest, and officers believe everyone involved with the operation was present. The community will mourn of the loss of Officer Dick Alpert, who was killed in the operation. Alpert was a long-standing, respected member of the Tichfield Police Station. He was shot in the line of duty by an unknown shooter. Constituting the apprehended were Edward Beaupre, Jonathon Helwig, Chandler Davenport, Faynola Jacobs, and John Locke. The operation has been going on from some months according to documents seized at the scene of apprehension. London police agencies were tipped off by an anonymous citizen, and remind denizens of London to report suspicious activity to local police forces.

90 NW

Elle Fanning opens the door of a small, red flat.

"Can I help you gentlemen?"

"We're from Scotland Yard. Do you mind if we come in and ask you some questions?"

"Not at all, please come in."

We enter a run down and messy apartment. There are dishes piled near the sink, clothes strewn across the floor, and random other objects are tossed about. There is a small, wooden crate partially hidden behind a sofa. Only the word 'Taylor' can be seen.

"What can I help you with? I know how this works. My father was a police officer. Let me know what I can do for you."

"Thank you, Ms. Fanning. We stopped in your establishment, The Pavilion, earlier and spoke to Annette Verlaine. She told us that Sherlock Holmes had been in earlier that day."

"Yes, he was. I know Sherlock Holmes. My father was on the Tichfield Police Force and worked with Holmes several times. I have a great respect for the cases Sherlock Holmes helped with for various agencies. Anyway, he was in The Pavilion yesterday. It was around 2 o'clock I think. He was acting very strange, but, then, I've always heard he's a very strange man. My father once told me that he doesn't see the world the same way we all do. Mr. Holmes was acting paranoid, though I don't know why. I insisted on making his tea myself since I have been a great fan of his for a long time, but to my surprise, he didn't drink his tea, he just got up and left. I didn't see him again. I'm sorry I couldn't be of more help."

AREA SE

88 SE

As we enter Roberts & Parfitt, a clothing shop specializing in men's outerwear, we immediately notice a mannequin dressed up similar to Sherlock Holmes.

"And a bello there to you fine gentlemen," a small, energetic man begins as he greets us near the door. "Do you like it? I modeled it after the great Sherlock Holmes- London's finest detective. You know Sherlock shops at our store. I'm thinking of adding a sign proclaiming such to our front window. What can I do you for?"

"Well, we're actually here investigating some leads from a fire last night that...claimed the life of Sherlock Holmes."

We watch as the man slumps against a table, bracing himself as the energy we saw merely a moment before races its way out of his body. "Dead?" He shakes his head. "I don't know what to say. I'm- I'm so sorry."

"Can you tell us the last time Sherlock stopped in for a purchase?"

"Uh, Sherlock actually stopped in yesterday around 5 o'clock. He charged a burgundy, tweed outer coat to his account, the kind he usually wears. He's been charging a lot of clothes lately. I figured he would make good on the payment, being famous and all, but..."

"Did you notice anything unusual?"

"No, he was chatty, strolled right in and right out, and when I asked if I could make a mannequin to look like him, he said, 'certainly'."

We thank him and walk outside.

Wiggins looks at Lestrade. "Sherlock charged clothes? That doesn't sound like him. He always accepts gifts, but he's not one to use credit."

"I'm more surprised by his acquiescing to the mannequin. Sherlock was humble and always liked to keep a low profile when possible."

AREA SW

2 SW

Langdale Pike greets us as we enter his office.

"I'm deeply sorry to hear about Sherlock Holmes, gentlemen."

"Thank you. Do you have any scoops for us, Langdale?"

"Not I." "Do you have anything to tell me about Sherlock's love life?"

5 SW

Lomax reports that he is sad to hear about Holmes, but that he has nothing to offer on this case.

8 SW

Mycroft Holmes, Sherlock's slightly larger and more handsome brother, greets us as we enter.

"Do you have any leads? Someone is going to pay for this."

"Mycroft, first of all we offer our condolences. You can rest assured that Scotland Yard is doing all we can to find out the cause of the fire that claimed your brother's life."

Mycroft nods, but it's clear that his heart isn't even in the statement. We know the Holmes brothers were close, and inside he has to be reeling.

"Mycroft, we're not merely here to offer our condolences. There was a witness that placed you near the scene of the crime last night before the fire occurred. Can you tell us about your comings and goings yesterday and your interactions with your brother?"

Mycroft manages a weak laugh. "You're not considering me a suspect in this are you?"

"We have nothing to indicate as such, Mycroft. To the contrary, we're hoping you can help us get to bottom of what happened last night. We know you'd never hurt your brother."

Mycroft seems satisfied. "I saw my brother twice yesterday. We met for lunch around 1 o'clock. He seemed fine. He told me he wanted me to come by his apartment later that night. I came by at 8:30 and all seemed normal. Sherlock met me out front instead of in his apartment, which I thought was odd, but not alarming. He was rather brusque with me, and told me to leave."

"Did he say or do anything suspicious while you talked to him?"

"No, not really. One thing that was odd was that he was dressed in a burgundy suit as opposed to his normal brown threads. That, in and of itself, isn't so suspicious, but Sherlock rarely changes clothes during the day. They even seemed to be brand new. Sherlock liked to "age" his clothes with a technique only he knew. He said it was unbecoming to appear too flashy. Hmm. He also approached me as I walked toward his apartment. He seemed in good spirits and had a light step to his gait."

"What did he talk to you about?"

"Well, I guess that was a bit odd. He kept saying my name during the conversation, but ultimately he just asked me if I wanted to go to the theater tonight, uh, I mean tomorrow, well, you know what I mean. Now that I think about it, he also asked to borrow money, which he never does. I gave him some. That's it. Does that help?"

"It may be too early to know. We thank you for your time, Mycroft. Believe me, Sherlock was a friend to all of us. If there is a reason to suspect foul play, we'll get to the bottom of it."

13 SW

The mood of Scotland Yard is quite somber today. Word of Sherlock's death has permeated through the entire law enforcement agency. Most people are in shock over Sherlock's death, though there are a few other newsworthy stories as well. Someone broke into De Vries Diamond overnight and someone was killed in Hyde Park early this morning— cause unknown.

22 SW

Murray meets with us in his lab.

"Hello, Gentlemen. I'm afraid I can't provide much help to you. I have been examining the iron box what was recovered from 221B Baker Street."

"Did you find anything interesting about the contents of the box?"

"Well, as it turns out...no. But it wasn't the contents that have my interest piqued. The inner ring of metal on the lip is partially warped from the heat of the blaze."

"So?"

"This tells me that the lid wasn't shut properly and latched. If I had to guess, I'd say someone quickly shut the

box while the fire was consuming the room."

"Thank you, Murray. I don't know how that's possible, but it's certainly very interesting."

52 SW

The small, dingy home of Ambroise Beaupre appears to have been vacant for a few days. The front door is not locked and pushes open. There is bread sitting, rotting, on the small square table in the kitchen. There is an address on a piece of paper on the table as well: 85 WC.

The bedroom is just as messy, but the bathroom contains something of interest. Another paper tacked to the wall. This one appears to be a message of some sort in a code.



63 SW

The Olympia Theater has a jovial, jowly-faced man at the ticket booth.

"Uh, oh, some officers, eh? What can I do for you? I'm thinking you're not here to buy tickets?"

"Unfortunately, no. Though we'd much rather be. Can you tell us if Sherlock Holmes has recently attended any performances here?"

"I know Holmes, we went to primary school together. Very eccentric guy. No, Sherlock hasn't been to the Olympia in quite a while. He attended frequently a few months ago when we had a run of our biggest hit The Scratchings on the Lighthouse. But then, you can't obtain the top talent for every show. Sorry I can't be of more help."

AREA WC

5 WC

The chief coordinator at the Central Carriage Stables reports that Sherlock Holmes was picked up twice yesterday. He was taken NW at around 1:45, but refused to give the driver a final destination, instead choosing to just get out at a random point. He was also taken to WC just before 6:00. He chose a random corner to get out on.

A driver steps forward, "I watched Sherlock get struck with a barrel yesterday in front of Ship and Turtle. That must have been around 5 o'clock. Some young lad that was loading supplies into the storage shed accidentally let a heavy pickle barrel loose as Holmes was walking by, and it struck him in the leg. He seemed pretty hurt by it, but refused to see a doctor. For what it's worth, that lad didn't seem all that shaken up about it."

Another driver pipes up, "I should tell you that last week I picked up Sherlock in a bad state. He was stumbling across the street and tripped on the sidewalk. He was drunk. Badly drunk. Luckily I've driven him a few times before. I dropped him off at Baker St., but he just sat on the sidewalk in front of his house. Poor guy. He couldn't even remember where he lived. He kept telling me I was going the wrong way."

11 WC

A bell chimes as we walk in Radford, Jones, & Co., a clothing shop that focuses on women's clothing and accessories. A polite, young woman at cash register greets us.

"Hello, can I interest you in anything or help you find something?"

"Do you sell men's clothing? Or have you heard of a man named Sherlock Holmes?"

"Oh, the detective that's always in the newspaper? I know of him, yes. Say, maybe he could solve the cause of that house fire I heard about this morning. But, no, we don't sell men's clothing."

"Thank you for your time."

14 WC

Disraeli O'Brian is on a trip to America and will be back in three months.

17 WC

A short trip to the Somerset House reveals nothing to help with the case.

18 WC

As we enter the Lyceum Theater, we observe a lot of shouting and arguing coming from the stage.

"How are we supposed to have opening night tonight if one of the stars is missing?" shouts a lean man with a thin mustache.

"You know Gerty. She's always late, but she always comes through. She'll be here," responds a woman in a floral print dress. She begins going over a dance number again with the dancers on stage, while the man finally takes note of our presence.

"Oh, I'm sorry. We're not open yet. You'll have to come back tonight for the opening. Everyone wants to see our new comedy, The Initiative of Dharma, it seems. What's not to love? Beautiful woman in a red dress trying to figure out life and all its insanity? I'm a firm believer that most problems in the world could be solved with a beautiful woman in a red dress."

"We didn't mean to give the wrong impression. I'm Inspector Lestrade from Scotland Yard, and we're here following a lead. Can you tell me if Sherlock Holmes has been here recently to attend any performances?"

The man shakes my hand, "Sorry. Name's Wayne Nelson, I manage the shows here at The Lyceum. Well, I don't know who that is that you mentioned, so I rightly couldn't say. I know that's not much help."

"Thanks anyway. We couldn't help but hear you shouting about a performer as we entered. Is everything alright?"

"Oh, ah, a ha. Our lead in the new show, Gertrude Helwig, hasn't shown up yet, but I'm sure she will before showtime. Nothing unusual there. I swear, you give the cast the day before the opening off, and they get cold feet before the show. Good luck with your quest, Gentlemen. Perhaps if you finish that quest, you can see who took the theater's mask off the wall in the dressing room."

28 WC

We arrive at the small apartment of Chandler Davenport and find no one home. Upon finding the front door open, we decide to enter the premises. Inside the apartment, we find a chest containing various makes and models of guns and boxes of ammunition. There is a newspaper clipping attached to the bottom of the lid of the crate.

25 November 1891 SENTENCES HANDED OUT TO WOULD-BE SMUGGLERS

Scotland Yard has made public the fate of the eight persons arrested in relation to a would-be smuggling ring at a London establishment. Evidence has implicated eight in an underground smuggling scheme. Seven suspects were arrested on site, while an eighth was picked up at her home. A ninth, Chandler Davenport was found innocent due to lack of evidence found at the crime scene. Those found guilty have been issued sentences ranging from ten to thirty years in prison.

34 WC

You find Gerald Locke sitting on his porch enjoying the afternoon sun.

"You boys look like business. What can I do for you?"

"Are you related to a 'John Locke'?"

Gerald sighs and begins, "John is my twin brother. What's wrong?"

"We're on an investigation, and it appears to circle back to cross paths with an incident your brother was involved in."

"The docks?"

"That's correct."

He sighs again and continues. "Look, John was into some bad stuff. There was a group of people using the docks as a smuggling location. They were using spare cargo holds on ships to import and export ancient antiques, drugs, you name it. Whatever they could acquire and find a buyer for. John told me that he was worried the whole thing would go south, and it appears he was right. I have no hard feelings about what happened. You do the crime, you get the punishment, as far as I'm concerned. However, I've heard through whispers that I'm in a small minority. You have to think, there were husbands, wives, fathers, mothers, and more that were sent away for a very long time. The last time I talked to John was

at the prison just a few days ago. He told me something big was going down, but he didn't know what. He also couldn't divulge his source. That's all I know."

85 WC

As we knock on the door to the apartment whose address we had seen earlier, we're greeted by a homely, brown-haired woman who identifies herself as Laura Parker.

"Yes, can I help you?"

"Excuse me M'am, we're looking for Ambroise Beaupre. This address was listed on a paper at his apartment. Do you know Ambroise?"

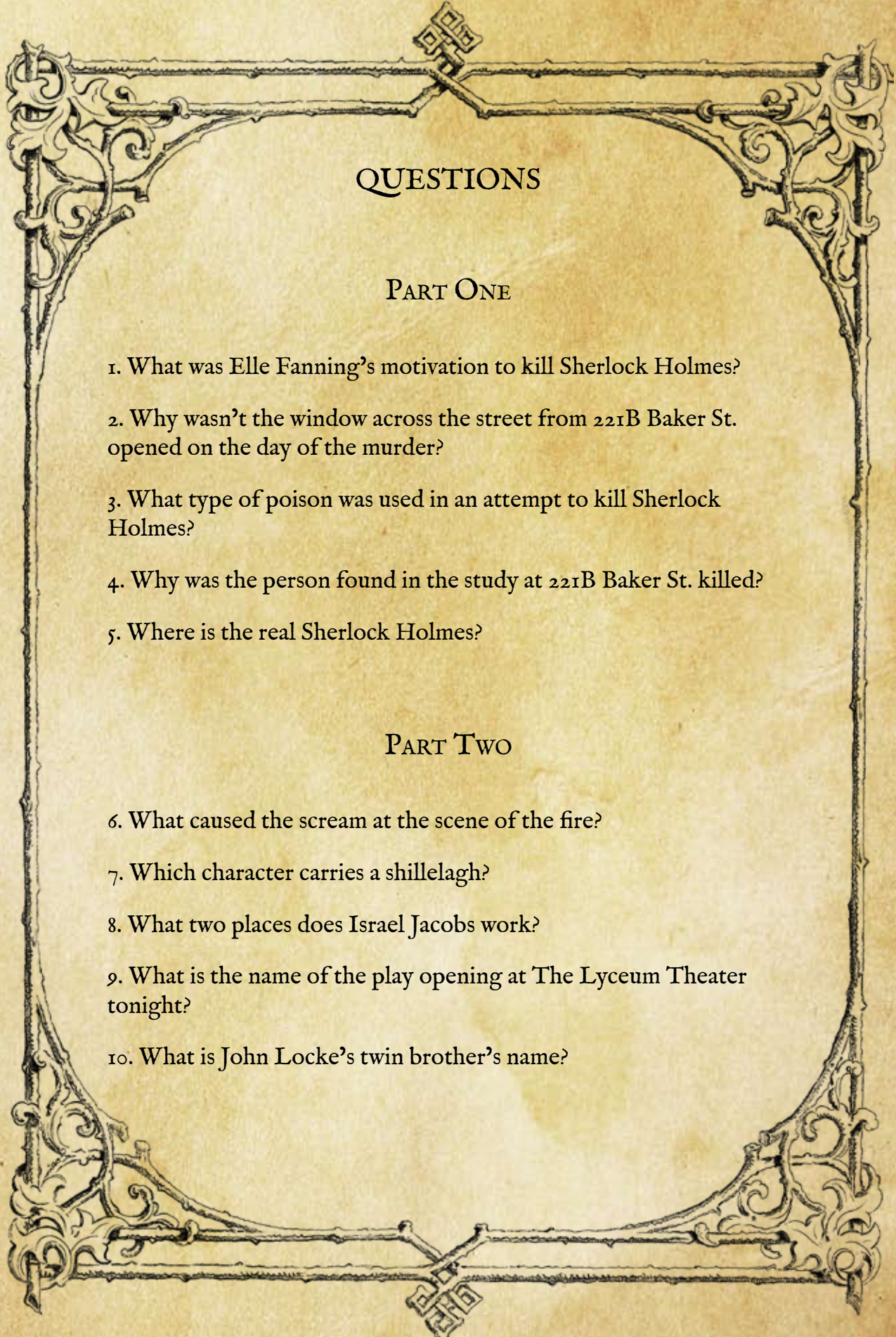
"Yeah, I know him. I used to date his brother, Edward, before, well, I'm sure you know."

"We do, M'am. Have you seen either of the Beaupre brothers lately?"

"No, I'm sorry I haven't. Ambroise was pretty mad after Edward was put up. I thought he left town. I haven't seen him since Edward... Well, I'm sorry I couldn't have been of more help."

94 WC

The man at the Allegro Theater has nothing to report other than Sherlock Holmes has previously attended plays there.



QUESTIONS

PART ONE

1. What was Elle Fanning's motivation to kill Sherlock Holmes?
2. Why wasn't the window across the street from 221B Baker St. opened on the day of the murder?
3. What type of poison was used in an attempt to kill Sherlock Holmes?
4. Why was the person found in the study at 221B Baker St. killed?
5. Where is the real Sherlock Holmes?

PART TWO

6. What caused the scream at the scene of the fire?
7. Which character carries a shillelagh?
8. What two places does Israel Jacobs work?
9. What is the name of the play opening at The Lyceum Theater tonight?
10. What is John Locke's twin brother's name?

SOLUTION

We meet with John Watson and walk through the streets of London discussing the case.

"Well, Lestrade, was Sherlock murdered, or was it truly an accident?"

"This was mostly a revenge case, Watson. Sherlock Holmes had stopped many criminals in his day, and he was bound to make some enemies being in that business. This particular act against Sherlock Holmes was payment for the incident involving the smuggling ring at the Outer Docks two years ago. Five people were put in jail for the crime; a sixth was let off on a lack of evidence."

"And they wanted revenge?"

"I'm sure they did, Watson, but they didn't have a chance, being in prison at the time. However, each person in jail had relatives that were equally upset about their family being placed in jail. But, how then did the relatives find out about Sherlock Holmes's involvement? Someone had to let that news circulate throughout London, so it would be heard. Once that was out, that someone sent out invitations to the remaining relatives of the prisoners. But where to meet? The lone officer killed in that operation, Dick Alpert, had a daughter, Elle Fanning, who knew it was Sherlock's tip that ended with her father dead. She agreed to host the meeting at her restaurant, The Pavilion. Three of the other relatives responded, Ambroise Beaupre, Gertrude Helwig, and Israel Jacobs. The final member of the "Pentacle" was Chandler Davenport, who had been earlier let off. He was upset that his smuggling ring has been stopped. Ironic that Fanning hosted the meeting, since, as the sharpshooter, it was Chandler Davenport that had probably ultimately killed her father, not Sherlock Holmes. Only John Locke, brother of Gerald Locke, refused to answer the invitation."

"So a dastardly plot was hatched, Lestrade. Was Davenport the leader then?"

"I'm afraid not. He was more a general in this case, Watson. The true leader coded his name in the note that was found at Beaupre's apartment. Professor Moriarty."

"Moriarty! He was behind the whole thing?"

"Yes, Davenport was merely the person who worked on-site at the smuggling ring. The majority of the profits were being filtered to Moriarty to bankroll other criminal schemes. Regardless, the five worked out a plan that would be sure to take care of Sherlock once and for all. However, something occurred that they could not have foreseen."

"Which was?"

"Marvin Pemberton."

"Who?"

"Marvin Pemberton, who had been moonlighting as a Sherlock Holmes impersonator. Pemberton had been dressing like Holmes for a while now, and he was getting so good at it that he even fooled Sherlock's neighbors and Sherlock's own brother, Mycroft. He ran up bills around town using Sherlock's good name as a form of credit. Unfortunately, Pemberton had chosen a very dangerous time to pretend to be Sherlock Holmes."

"So what happened?"

"It started around 2 o'clock yesterday when Sherlock wandered into The Pavilion. He was on the hunt for the Pentacle just as we were. Sherlock had found the well-placed and obvious note in Ambroise Beaupre's flat and went to Fanning's restaurant as they had hoped. Fanning poured cyanide into his drink, attempting to kill him, but Sherlock saw through that."

"You don't say. He was to be poisoned?"

"Well, the Pentacle wasn't taking any chances. Though Fanning had failed, they had arranged a few other surprises yesterday for Holmes."

Lestrade pauses as a woman on a bike crosses their intersection. Wiggins waves, and they continue walking.

"Sherlock received an unplanned surprise when he walked past the Ship and Turtle, and Israel Jacobs recognized him and threw a pickle barrel at Holmes, injuring Holmes's leg and leaving him with a limp. Holmes made it home and hid in his apartment, probably out of fear of Chandler Davenport, the best shooter in London, being after him. This is where things get complicated."

"More complicated than what's already taken place?"

"I'm afraid so, Watson. Mycroft came to visit his brother as they had previously agreed upon. Sherlock probably had intended on letting Mycroft in on the situation with the Pentacle. Unfortunately, Marvin Pemberton had shown up early for his meeting with Sherlock. It was Pemberton, not Holmes, who met Mycroft outside the apartment. Pemberton, having no knowledge of the Pentacle or the danger at hand, said what he could to get Mycroft to leave, promising to go to the theater with him the next day. Pemberton entered the house and spoke to Holmes. While they were conversing, another part of the plot was set into motion. Israel Jacobs had procured another part time job at the Camden House for the sole purpose of having a place to watch Sherlock Holmes. Chandler Davenport used this room to take a very difficult shot, a shot he made more difficult by using a short range weapon and leaving the window shut."

"And he shot Holmes?"

"Chandler was also fooled by Pemberton's disguise. He shot whom he thought was Holmes. Hitting Pemberton cleanly and killing him instantly. Holmes couldn't risk leaving the house with Davenport still watching, so he stayed inside, hoping the chance to escape would present itself. The Pentacle was too thorough, though. Ambroise Beaupre was, in the meantime, pouring kerosene on 221B Baker St., and Gertrude Helwig lit the match that started the blaze. They left quickly, who would have waited for a man who'd just been shot to escape, but not quickly enough. Helwig burned her arm in the process, but both made it away. Another person, dressed in black was seen leaving the crime scene. This is, perhaps, the most interesting part of this whole case, Watson."

"I don't follow you, Lestrade."

"Ah, but you did. To our destination."

Watson stops walking and stares at A. W. Faber's stationery office, and as he does so, the door opens, and Sherlock Holmes exits, limping badly.

"It took you long enough," Sherlock begins. "Did Watson slow you down too much?"

Watson runs and hugs his friend as Lestrade and Wiggins smile.

ANSWERS

Part One

1. Elle Fanning was mad at Sherlock for his tip that lead to her father being shot in the operation at the Outer Docks.
2. The window was purposefully left shut by Chandler Davenport who was trying to create a more difficult shot in his assassination of Sherlock Holmes.
3. Elle Fanning poured cyanide into Sherlock Holmes's tea.
4. Chandler Davenport (and to another degree Ambroise Beaupre and Gertrude Helwig) believed Marvin Pemberton was the real Sherlock Holmes.
5. Sherlock Holmes managed to get a hint to Lestrade before 221B Baker St. was annihilated. He is hiding at A. W. Faber's stationery shop as indicated by reading the first letter of each word in the note to Lestrade.

Part Two

6. Gertrude Helwig was accidentally burned when she and Ambroise Beaupre lit Sherlock's home on fire.
7. Ambroise Beaupre carries a shillelagh.
8. Israel Jacobs works part time at both the Camden House and the Ship and Turtle.
9. *The Initiative of Dharma* opens at The Lyceum Theater tonight.
10. John Locke's twin brother's name is Gerald.

PUZZLE NOTES

Professor Moriarty left his name hidden in the note found in Ambroise Beaupre's flat. The coded letters (capitalized, in this case) do not rearrange to make a word, rather they are place markers. The letter to the right of each spell M-O-R-I-A-R-T-Y, the mastermind behind the attempt to kill Sherlock Holmes.

WRITTEN BY: CODY FLEMING

GRAPHICAL LAYOUT BY: David Czechowski

COVER FONT: <http://dirt2.com/fonts/dead-secretary/>

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INSIDE COVER TEXTURE: Old Alcatraz Interior Wall, David Czechowski, 2016

WATSON POSE: "A very seedy felt hat", by Sidney Paget, 1892

NOTE 1: <http://www.bashcorpo.dk/textures.php>

NOTE 2: <https://www.flickr.com/photos/myphotoshopbrushes/3242490894>

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